modernization ‘was the need to embrace high technology, particularly information technology, to transform the Indian economy and society’. Raghavan argues that Rajiv understood this would require ‘greater and more adroit engagement with the world and that foreign policy had to be geared towards securing these objectives’.[117] Rajiv understood the importance of economic growth not only for domestic reasons but also to raise India’s status in the world. He also tied this in with the desire to build ‘a more equitable world economic order in which the developing countries will have a large voice’.[118]

In his speech at the Non-Aligned Movement (NAM) summit in Harare in 1986 Rajiv talked about the need for ‘revolutionizing’ the international economic order by ‘tangible, broad-based cooperation’ amongst the NAM countries. He spoke about the need to share skills, technology through an information grid and the need to set up a multinational system like the Global System of Trade Preferences. Rajiv believed this would strengthen ‘the South’s negotiating power in parleys with the North’.[119]

Thus, to the Nehruvian legacy, Rajiv added the need to use deeper economic and technological ties to create a new global economic order. Unlike Nehru and Indira, Rajiv trusted the market and did not see the state as the sole and key actor in the economic arena. Not only did he start economic reforms that were later taken forward in 1991, but he also voiced a desire to secure for India all advantages of globalization and the attending technological and economic changes. He sought an economic order in which all countries, including developing ones, would have ‘a fair opportunity’ to become prosperous. [120] Rajiv seemed to think that seeking greater power for the global South would help build India’s global weight.

In Rajiv’s lexicon, words like ‘common humanity’, ‘human dignity’ and ‘peaceful co-existence’ were combined with ‘survival’, ‘security’ and ‘independence’. For him the ideal world was one where ‘each of us, irrespective of size or wealth or military strength, is the equal of every other